

Deployment checklist

The Living Craft

What this helps you decide

Make a release operable by naming the action, owner, evidence and recovery path. Adapt the checklist to the system's risks. A small team still needs deliberate boundaries; a long checklist is not a substitute for effective controls.

Worked example

Illustrative case: a service deploys successfully, but the scheduled task that prepares the next period's output is absent. A homepage check passes while the product's main work is not happening.

A useful verification therefore checks both service health and expected job completion. It records when output was due, whether it appeared and who responds if it does not. Recovery must recognise completed work before retrying it.

Review before release

Area	Check and evidence
Change	Identify the version, owner, purpose and dependencies.
Fast checks	Run relevant type, static and unit checks; record what they do not cover.
Environment	Verify configuration parity deliberately; separate secrets and production access.
Data	Review migrations, backup/recovery and compatibility with the previous version.
Permissions	Test that routine development and review cannot modify production data.
Promotion	Record the approver, evidence and exact version being promoted.
Recovery	Explain rollback or forward recovery, including irreversible data changes.

Review after release

Area	Check and evidence
Service	Verify a meaningful task as well as a health endpoint.
Schedule	Verify jobs exist and expected work completes; detect missing success.
Observability	Check useful logs and alerts without exposing unnecessary personal data.
Response	Name who responds, how they are reached and what recovery they can perform.
Repetition	Test that retries and catch-up work do not duplicate completed actions.
Deferrals	Record omitted controls, their reason, owner and revisit trigger.

Complete the release record

Use the CSV to record status, owner, evidence, unresolved risk and follow-up for each area. A check marked “not applicable” needs a reason. Do not mark a release complete solely because the deployment command succeeded.

Limits and next step

This checklist does not prescribe your deployment stack or certify a secure system. Review it against your architecture and obligations. Which missing control presents the most consequential failure for your next release?